# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL DE CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A V-A**

**Varianta 2**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *overseas, Head of State, official, duty, Majesty, service, Queen, ministers, throne, reign.*

When Her (1) _____ acceded to the (2) _____ aged just 25, her life changed overnight from that of a young naval wife and mother to a busy (3) _____. She was to become known for her sense of (4) _____ and her devotion to a life of (5) _____, and was an important figurehead for the UK and the Commonwealth during times of both crisis and celebration.

Travel in the UK and (6) _____ dominated much of Her Majesty's working life. Before she became (7) _____, she had said, "There is none of my father's subjects from the oldest to the youngest whom I do not wish to greet." During her (8) _____, she visited every realm and every region of the UK, returning to some many times over.

Though much of Her Majesty's daily working life was spent in contact with her UK and Commonwealth (9) _____ and representatives, it was her presence in these places during her many (10) _____ visits which carried the most significance for those who lived there.

*(https://www.royal.uk/queen-elizabeth-iis-life-and-reign)*

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the two columns:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Albus | a. Brown |
| 2. Aunt | b. Malfoy |
| 3. Lavender | c. Lockhart |
| 4. Cornelius | d. Granger |
| 5. Draco | e. Voldemort |
| 6. Ginny | f. Petunia |

| | |
|---|---|
| 7. Gilderoy | g. Bell |
| 8. Hermione | h. Weasley |
| 9. Katie | i. Dumbledore |
| 10. Lord | j. Fudge |

(Adapted from *https://www.buzzfeed.com/hannahmarder/can-you-name-a-harry-potter-character-for-every-letter-of*)

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There is ONE extra heading you do not need to use:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A. How much is the English tea bus tour? | C. About | E. What does the afternoon tea bus tour include? |
| B. Why choose this London bus tour? | D. Can I choose my seat? | F. Is the bus wheelchair accessible? |

**The English Tea Bus**

| 1 | |
|---|---|

2

Combine the timeless tastes of a traditional afternoon tea with a panoramic tour of the city aboard *Golden Tours' The English Tea Bus*.

Book tickets for this fun afternoon tea bus with a panoramic tour of London to explore the streets of the capital from the comfort of your seat, while savouring delectable sandwiches and pastries. All with a side helping of special views of top landmarks such as the London Eye and St Paul's Cathedral.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

This family-friendly afternoon tea tour in London includes a panoramic bus tour of central London and an afternoon tea served on board. As part of your afternoon tea, enjoy a glass of prosecco on arrival and a selection of teas.

Additional food and drink options are not included in the price of your ticket.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

You can purchase different ticket options, depending on whether you wish to be seated upstairs or downstairs:

Lower Deck (downstairs area): £49 per adult and £44 per child (5 to 15 years).

Upper Deck (upstairs area): £59 per adult and £54 per child (5 to 15 years).

Premium Upper Deck (upstairs area located at the front of the bus for the best views): £69 per adult and £64 per child (5 to 15 years).

| | |
|---|---|
| 4 | |

Highlights of the afternoon tea bus tour include:

Sightseeing bus tour of iconic London landmarks.

Afternoon tea experience.

Glass of prosecco (or soft drink) on arrival.

Fantastic views from the upper deck.

Family-friendly afternoon tea tour.

| | |
|---|---|
| 5 | |

You can choose between three seating options when booking your tickets for the afternoon tea bus tour: downstairs (Lower Deck), upstairs (Upper Deck) or upstairs at the front of the bus (Premium Upper Deck) for the best views. Please note, tables may be shared with other guests.

*(https://www.visitlondon.com/things-to-do/place/48299976-afternoon-tea-bus-with-panoramic-tour-of-london)*

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (80-100 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.** 3

*(pinterest.fr)*

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

4

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A VI-A**

**Varianta 1**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *King, Queen, Buckingham Palace, London, Royal, family, United Kingdom, Charles III, monarchy, Elizabeth II.*

The (1) _____ of the (2) _____ is one of the most famous in the world. It plays an important role in the life of the country and is a strong symbol of national identity. The system of government in the UK is called a (3) _____, where the ruler is a (4) _____ or a (5) _____.

Today, the head of state is (6) _____. He became king after the death of Queen (7) _____, who ruled for more than 70 years. She was one of the most respected leaders in modern history. Members of the royal family take part in official ceremonies, charity events, and international visits, representing the country around the world.

The royal residence in (8) _____ is called (9) _____. It is a famous landmark visited by many tourists every year. People often gather there to watch important events and celebrations. The British (10) _____ Family is known for its long history, customs, and strong sense of duty, which continue to this day. 1 _____

(Adapted from *The Royal Family (www.royal.uk)*)

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the information in column A with the information in column B:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Elizabeth II | a. is the current king of the UK. |
| 2. James I | b. was a very famous queen who ruled for over 70 years. |
| 3. Victoria | c. had six wives. |
| 4. Henry VIII | d. is known as the *People's Princess*. |
| 5. William the Conqueror | e. became king after Elizabeth I. |
| 6. Charles III | f. is the wife of Prince William. |

| | |
|---|---|
| 7. Elizabeth I | g. was queen during a long period called the Victorian Age. |
| 8. Diana | h. is the son of King Charles III. |
| 9. William | i. was queen in the 16th century and never married. |
| 10. Catherine | j. won the Battle of Hastings. |

(Adapted from *The Royal Family (www.royal.uk)*)

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There is ONE extra heading you do not need to use:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A. A famous British celebration | C. A popular sport in the UK | E. A well-known British city |
| B. Life in a royal home | D. A traditional British meal | F. School life in Britain |

| 1 | |
|---|---|

London is the capital of the United Kingdom and one of the most famous cities in the world. It is a large and busy place, with many tourists visiting every year. People can see important landmarks such as Big Ben, the Houses of Parliament and Buckingham Palace. The River Thames runs through the city and offers beautiful views. London is also known for its museums, theatres and parks, where people can relax and learn new things. 2

| 2 | |
|---|---|

Football is extremely popular in the United Kingdom and is played by people of all ages. Many children start playing it at school or in local parks with their friends. There are many famous teams, such as Manchester United, Liverpool and Chelsea. At weekends, fans watch atches on television or go to the stadium to support their favourite team. Football brings people together and is an important part of British culture.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

Afternoon tea is a traditional British custom that started in the 19th century. It usually takes place in the afternoon, between lunch and dinner. People drink tea, often with milk, and eat small sandwiches, cakes and scones with jam and cream. Today, many hotels and cafés offer afternoon tea as a special experience. It is a relaxing way to spend time with friends or family and enjoy a calm moment during the day.

| 4 | |
|---|---|

Buckingham Palace is one of the most famous buildings in London and it is the official residence of the British monarch. The palace has many rooms, including large halls used for

ceremonies and important events. Tourists often gather outside to watch the Changing of the Guard, a colourful and popular tradition. The royal family lives and works there, and the palace is an important symbol of the United Kingdom.

| 5 | |
|---|---|

Bonfire Night is celebrated every year on the 5th of November in the United Kingdom. It remembers the failure of the Gunpowder Plot in 1605. On this evening, people light bonfires and enjoy fireworks displays. Families and friends gather together, eat traditional food like baked potatoes and toffee apples, and spend time outdoors. It is a fun and exciting event, especially for children.

(*https://learnenglishkids.britishcouncil.org/reading-practice/the-uk*)

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (80-100 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**

(*AI Generated Artwork – NightCafe Creator creator.nightcafe.studio*)

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A VII-A**

**Varianta 1**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *reign, course, Jubilees, accession, execution, faced, rivalry, madness, challenges, flight.*

During the period from the (1) _____ of James I in 1603 until the death of Queen Victoria, the British monarchy (2) _____ a number of (3) _____ and underwent a profound change. The (4) _____ will seek to chart the ups and downs of the monarchy during this period including the (5) _____ of one monarch and the (6) _____ into exile of another, the (7) _____ between two royal houses (the Stuarts and the Hanoverians), the (8) _____ of King George III and extravagance of his sons, and the long (9) _____ of Queen Victoria culminating in her hugely popular Silver and Golden (10) _____.

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

1 _____

**II. Match the information in column A with the information in column B:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. The Normans, led by William the Conqueror, invaded England. | a. Queen Elizabeth II |
| 2. This king had six wives and broke away from the Catholic Church. | b. 1914-1918 |
| 3. The Great Fire of London destroyed much of the city center. | c. 1066 |
| 4. This queen reigned for 63 years during the Industrial Revolution. | d. William Shakespeare |
| 5. King John was forced to sign this document to limit his power. | e. Henry VIII |
| 6. England fought against Germany and its allies in World War I. | f. 1666 |
| 7. This famous playwright wrote during the Elizabethan Era. | g. Queen Victoria |
| 8. The Spanish Armada tried to invade England during her reign. | h. Magna Carta |
| 9. She was the longest-reigning monarch in British history. | i. Queen Elizabeth I |
| 10. The Romans left Britain after occupying it for centuries. | j. 410 AD |

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There is ONE extra heading you do not need to use:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A. A slightly chaotic coronation | C. A headstrong head of state | E. Victoria becomes Queen |
| B. Victoria and Albert redefines what it means to be Queen | D. The end of the Victorian age | F. A royal white wedding |

| 1 | |
|---|---|

Queen Victoria restored the reputation of a monarchy tarnished by the extravagance of her royal uncles. She also shaped a new role for the Royal Family, reconnecting it with the public through civic duties. At just 4ft 11in tall, Victoria was a towering presence as a symbol of her Empire. She and her husband Albert and their nine children came to symbolise a new, confident age.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

Victoria succeeded her uncle William IV, just weeks after her 18th birthday. Her first request was an hour alone, something denied to her until then. 2

Victoria moved to Buckingham Palace making it her official royal residence in London. She began exerting her will by exiling her mother to live in distant rooms. She also banned John Conroy the courtier who made her childhood miserable – from her state apartments. The young Queen was charmed by her first prime minister, Lord Melbourne, who was both fatherly and admiring. She became the richest woman in the world after Parliament granted her an annuity of £385,000.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

A crowd of 400,000 gathered on the streets of London to catch a glimpse of the Queen on her Coronation Day. She was crowned in Westminster Abbey.

She wore robes of white satin and red velvet. The five-hour ceremony was a little chaotic as the Dean of Westminster, who had presided over previous coronations, was ill. Victoria was handed the orb at the wrong moment and the Archbishop of Canterbury forced a ring on the wrong finger, which took her an hour to remove. After the ceremony Victoria returned to Buckingham Palace for a family banquet and watched the fireworks.

| 4 | |
|---|---|

Victoria fell in love with her first cousin Prince Albert of Saxe-Coburg and Gotha when he visited Britain in 1839.

As head of state she had to propose to him. Albert took on the role of 'moral tutor' to Victoria. Victoria fell pregnant soon after her wedding and gave birth to her daughter Victoria nine months later. The Queen hated childbirth and suffered postnatal depression. Despite this she had nine children with Albert over 16 years. Victoria, with the assistance of Albert, created a newly visible constitutional monarchy to stem a growing republican movement in Britain.

Victoria became patron of 150 institutions, including dozens of charities, while Albert supported the development of educational museums. The couple went on civic visits to industrial towns such as Leeds, and attended military reviews to support the armed forces. Together they helped stem criticism that the Royal Family didn't earn its keep.

The Victoria Cross was introduced by Queen Victoria to honour acts of great bravery during the Crimean War. It was awarded on merit instead of rank. She also awarded the first Victoria Crosses personally to 62 men at a ceremony at Hyde Park in 1857. It was the first time officers and men had been decorated together.

Prince Albert died at the age of 42. The Queen was inconsolable with grief and wore mourning for the rest of her life.

| 5 | |
|---|---|

Aged 81, Victoria died after weeks of ill health. Her son and heir Edward VII and her grandson Emperor Wilhelm II of Germany were at her deathbed.

The Queen ruled over an Empire that covered a quarter of the globe with 400 million subjects, but she never forgot the men who supported her. She requested that Albert's dressing gown and a plaster cast of his hand be placed in her coffin. She also asked for a lock of John Brown's hair and his picture to be put in her hand. Lastly, she left orders that Abdul Karim be among the principal mourners at her funeral. She was an indomitable monarch who, even at the end, was adept at getting her own.

*(bbc.co.uk/teach/articles/z73rnrd)*

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (120-150 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**

*(AI generated)*

4

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediţia a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A VIII-A**

**Varianta 2**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *explorers, Golden, religion, heart, reign, monarchs, queen, nation, playwright, Church.*

The daughter of Henry VIII and Anne Boleyn, Elizabeth I (1558–1603), is one of the most famous and successful (1) _____in history. She ruled England for 44 years. Because she never married, she is often called "The Virgin Queen." When Elizabeth became (2) _____, England was in a difficult position. The country was divided by religion, poor, and at risk of being attacked by powerful neighbors like Spain and France.

One of her biggest challenges was (3) _____. Her father had broken away from Rome, but her sister, Mary I, had tried to make England Catholic again. Elizabeth found a "middle way." She established the (4) _____ of England as a Protestant church but allowed some Catholic traditions to remain. This helped bring peace to her people.

The most dangerous moment of her (5) _____ was in 1588. King Philip II of Spain sent a massive fleet of 130 ships, called the Spanish Armada, to invade England. 1 _____

Elizabeth famously went to her troops at Tilbury and gave a powerful speech. She said:

"I know I have the body of a weak and feeble woman; but I have the (6) _____ and stomach of a king, and of a king of England too."

Through a mix of clever English tactics and a violent storm at sea, the Spanish fleet was defeated. This victory made Elizabeth a hero and England a major world power.

Elizabeth's reign is often called the (7) _____ Age because art and literature flourished. This was the time of William Shakespeare, the world's most famous (8) _____. People flocked to theaters like "The Globe" to see his plays.

(9) _____ like Sir Francis Drake also sailed around the world, claiming new lands and bringing back gold and spices. By the time Elizabeth died in 1603, England was a wealthy, stable, and confident (10) _____.

*(https://www.rct.uk/discover/school-and-family-resources/a-focus-on-the-life-of-queen-elizabeth-ii)*

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the information in column A with the information in column B:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Henry VIII broke away from the Catholic Church in Rome because he wanted to marry his second wife, | a. Queen Elizabeth I. |
| 2. The Magna Carta was a famous document signed in 1215 that | b. Elizabeth I. |
| 3. The Spanish Armada was a giant fleet of ships that tried to invade England during the reign of | c. the Yorks and the Lancasters. |
| 4. The Industrial Revolution began in England during the | d. Anne Boleyn. |
| 5. The Battle of Hastings in 1066 was a turning point because | e. over 4,000 years ago. |
| 6. The Tudor Period saw the reigns of famous monarchs like Henry VIII and his daughter | f. Viking invaders in the 9th century. |
| 7. The Wars of the Roses were a series of famous battles between two royal families, | g. limited the power of the King for the first time. |
| 8. Stonehenge is a world-famous prehistoric monument in England that was built | h. from 1837 until 1901, which was the longest reign in British history at that time. |
| 9. King Alfred the Great is famous for defending his kingdom against | i. 18th century and changed the way goods were manufactured. |
| 10. Queen Victoria ruled the United Kingdom for 63 years, | j. it brought Norman French culture and language to England. |

2

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There is ONE extra heading you do not need to use:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| A. The End of the Tudor Dynasty | C. The Decline of the English Economy | E. A Path to the Throne |
| B. Defying the Spanish Empire | D. The Elizabethan Religious Settlement | F. An Explosion of Culture and Discovery |

**Queen Elizabeth I: The Great Queen**

| 1 | |
|---|---|

Elizabeth's early life was marked by extreme political instability and personal danger. As the daughter of Henry VIII and his ill-fated second wife, Anne Boleyn, Elizabeth's legitimacy was often questioned by those who remained loyal to the Catholic Church. Following the death of her half-brother Edward VI, she survived a tense period of imprisonment in the Tower of London under her sister, Mary I. Despite these threats to her life, she eventually ascended to the throne in 1558, inheriting a nation divided by religious conflict and deep financial debt.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

One of the most significant achievements of her early reign was the establishment of a stable religious identity for England. Elizabeth sought a *middle way* to reduce the violent tension between Catholics and Protestants. Through the Act of Supremacy and the Act of Uniformity, she established a Protestant Church of England that nevertheless retained some traditional rituals. This pragmatic approach allowed her to consolidate her power and prevent a civil war, providing the internal peace necessary for the country to grow. 3

| 3 | |
|---|---|

The defining military moment of the Elizabethan era occurred in 1588, when King Philip II of Spain launched the Spanish Armada. This massive fleet was intended to overthrow Elizabeth and restore Catholicism to England. However, the English navy, led by figures such as Sir Francis Drake, utilized superior maneuverability and fire ships to disrupt the Spanish formation. A powerful storm, later dubbed the *Protestant Wind*, finished what the navy had started, and the defeat of the Armada cemented England's status as a dominant maritime power.

| 4 | |
|---|---|

During Elizabeth's forty-four-year reign, England experienced a cultural *Golden Age*. The arts thrived under her patronage, most notably in the works of William Shakespeare and Christopher Marlowe, whose plays transformed English literature. Simultaneously, the spirit of exploration was born; navigators like Walter Raleigh attempted to establish colonies in North America, while others sought new trade routes to the East. This period of expansion and creativity significantly altered England's global influence and national identity.

| | |
|---|---|
| 5 | |

Elizabeth famously refused to marry, despite constant pressure from her advisors to provide an heir. By remaining the *Virgin Queen*, she maintained total control over her government and avoided the political complications of a foreign husband. When she died in 1603, the Tudor line came to an end, and the throne passed to her cousin, James VI of Scotland. Nevertheless, she left behind a kingdom that was far more prosperous, unified, and influential than the one she had inherited nearly half a century earlier.

*(https://www.biography.com/authors-history of the Great Britain)*

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (120-150 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**

*(AI genetared)*

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A IX-A**

**Varianta 3**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *Catholicism, religious, Church, abbeys, Henry VIII, the reign, 1530s, impulse, monasteries, refusal.*

**The Old Order**

Before Henry VIII's break with the papacy in the (1) _____, the Roman Catholic (2) _____ was all powerful in England. Only a small, persecuted minority questioned its doctrines. The early years of Henry's reign also saw traditional religious practices – such as pilgrimages, saints' holidays and (3) _____ plays – enthusiastically observed, together with the continued building and embellishment of churches that had been a major feature of (4) _____ of his father, Henry VII.

But when Henry declared himself Supreme Head of the Church in England in 1533, following the Pope's (5) _____ to sanction his divorce from Katherine of Aragon, his decision initiated the Reformation of English religion. With it came the sweeping away of institutions that symbolised medieval (6) _____ – and monasteries became the main focus of the king's attack. 1 _____

The monastic (7) _____ was long past its peak: excepting those run by stricter orders like the Carthusians, monasteries had become property-owning corporations – some very rich – with few inhabitants. Rievaulx Abbey, North Yorkshire, which had about 650 monks at its peak, had only about 20 by the 1530s; massive Castle Acre Priory, Norfolk, had only ten.

Some smaller (8) _____ had already closed because of a lack of recruits when (9) _____ forcibly suppressed all (10) _____ between 1536 and 1540.

*(https://www.english-heritage.org.uk/learn/story-of-england/tudors/religion/)*

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the information in column A with the information in column B:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Henry VIII was the second son of | a. in Greenwich, near London. |
| 2. When Henry VIII's elder brother, Arthur died in 1502, | b. Catherine of Aragon, Arthur's widow. |
| 3. Henry was an excellent student and athlete | c. in military adventure. |
| 4. When Henry became king at the age of 18, | d. six times. |
| 5. Henry VIII married | e. winter of Henry VII's reign. |
| 6. Henry VIII was born on 28th, June, | f. Henry became the heir to the throne. |
| 7. Henry VIII promised England the joys of spring after the long | g. great things were expected of him. |
| 8. The unpopular means for governing the realm soon | h. Henry VII and Elizabeth, daughter of Edward IV. |
| 9. Soon after his accession, Henry married | i. who enjoyed hunting and dancing. |
| 10. More serious was Henry's determination to engage | j. reappeared because they were necessary. |

2

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There is THREE extra headings you do not need to use:**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| A. The Arrival in England | B. The Ancestors | C. The Trouble in Scotland | D. A Disastrous Mistake |
| E. The First Castle | F. Mary at Carlisle | G. Years of Captivity | H. The 15th and the 16th Centuries |

| 1 | |
|---|---|

Born in 1542, Mary became Queen of Scotland when she was just six days old. During her childhood Scotland was ruled by regents. In 1558 she married Francis, the heir to the French

crown, and in July 1559 he became king, uniting the thrones of France and Scotland. Eight months earlier, Mary's cousin Elizabeth had become Queen of England.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

It was at this point that Mary decided to seek refuge in England. Her supporters begged her to stay in Scotland or head for Catholic France. But she was convinced that Elizabeth – her cousin, and like her an anointed monarch – would help her raise an army to return to Scotland in triumph. Before leaving Scotland she wrote to Elizabeth requesting a meeting and sending a diamond ring as a token of her friendship.

Without waiting for a reply, she and 16 supporters made the four-hour crossing of the Solway Firth (the strait that forms part of the border between England and Scotland). They arrived at the port of Workington in Cumberland (modern-day Cumbria) in the early evening.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

Elizabeth sent Sir Francis Knollys, one of her trusted courtiers, to Carlisle to keep an eye on Mary. He was charmed by her in person:

She was a notable woman because she had no care for ceremonies beyond the acknowledgement of her royal estate; then she spoke freely to everyone, whatever their rank and showed a disposition to speak much and to be bold and to be pleasant and to be very familiar.



| 4 | |
|---|---|

Whatever Mary may have hoped, her decision to seek refuge in England was a disastrous mistake. It put Elizabeth in a difficult position. Privately she sympathised with Mary, as a fellow monarch who had been imprisoned and deposed. However, both she and her advisers – most forcefully her chief adviser, William Cecil – saw Mary as highly dangerous.

As a Catholic with a claim to the English throne, Mary's presence on English soil provided both a potential rallying point for Catholic rebels at home and a possible cause for invasion by Catholic powers abroad. If she was restored to the Scottish throne, England would be surrounded by Catholic countries. It suited the English to keep the Earl of Moray, Mary's half-brother and a Protestant, as regent in Scotland.

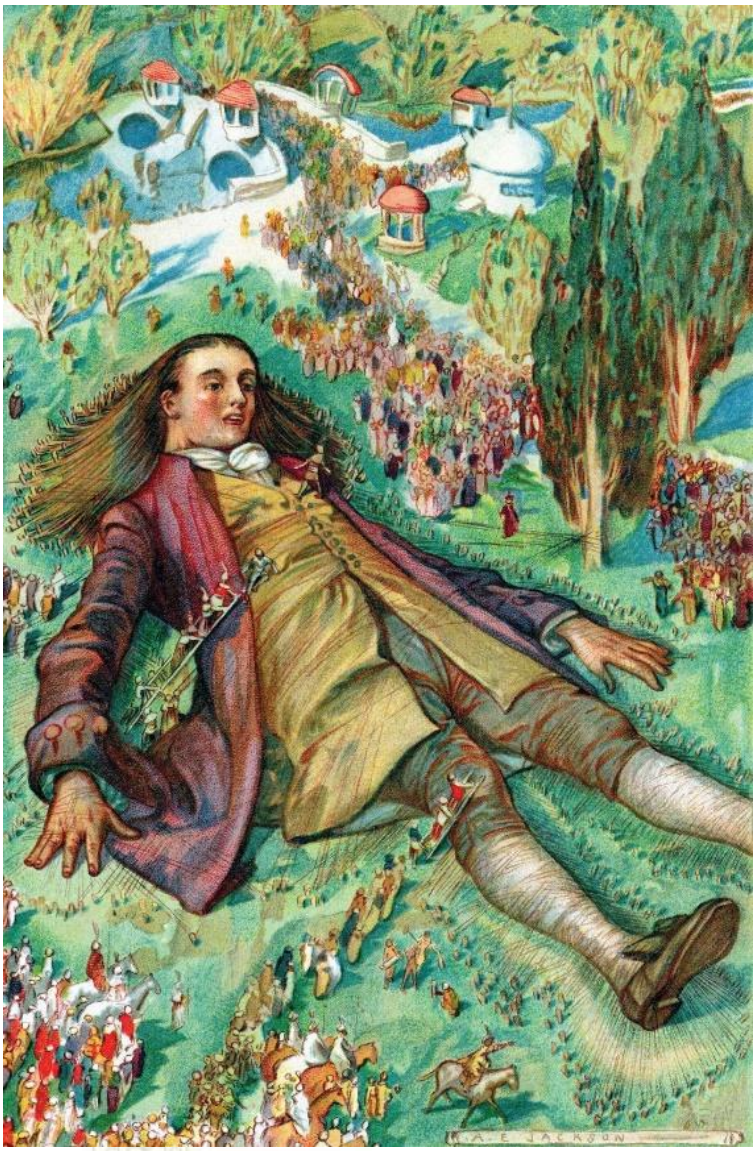
| 5 | |
|---|---|

Eventually, Mary reluctantly agreed to an inquiry into the charges against her. In late July 1568, before it began, she was moved south to Bolton Castle in Yorkshire. Four carriages, 20 packhorses and 23 riding horses were needed to convey her, her retinue and her belongings.

The inquiry began in October. Despite the Scots producing incriminating evidence against Mary (which was almost certainly falsified), in January 1569 Elizabeth declared that there was no proof either way. Yet although she was no longer accused of any crime, Mary remained in England. She was now without doubt a prisoner.

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (180-200 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**



*(AI generated)*

4

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A X-A**

**Varianta 2**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *golden, throne, religious, controversial, legacy, heir, dynasty, royal, far-reaching, reign.*

The Tudor (1) _____, which ruled England from 1485 to 1603, played a crucial role in shaping the nation's political, (2) _____, and cultural identity. It began with Henry VII, who secured the (3) _____ after the Wars of the Roses and worked to restore stability and strengthen (4) _____ authority. His careful financial and diplomatic policies laid the foundation for a more centralized monarchy.

His son, Henry VIII, is perhaps the most (5) _____ Tudor ruler. His desire for a male (6) _____led to the English Reformation, as he broke from the Roman Catholic Church and established the Church of England. This decision had (7) _____ consequences, triggering religious conflict and transforming the relationship between church and state. 1

The later Tudors, particularly Elizabeth I, oversaw a period often described as a (8) _____ age. Elizabeth's (9) _____ was marked by relative internal stability, the flourishing of the arts, and the expansion of English influence abroad. However, challenges such as threats from Catholic powers and internal conspiracies persisted.

Overall, the Tudor period was a time of profound transition, during which England evolved into a more unified and influential state, leaving a lasting (10) _____ on its institutions and culture.

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the information in column A with the information in column B:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. The first permanent theatre in London was built in | a. only in the daytime. |
| 2. Shakespeare's plays were performed in the | b. 1576. |
| 3. Theatrical performances took place | c. Thomas Kyd, Christopher Marlowe |

| | |
|---|---|
| | and Ben Jonson. |
| 4. The stage was surrounded by the audience | d. acting was not thought to be respectable. |
| 5. The stage had no curtains, there was no scenery, | e. Globe Theatre. |
| 6. The women's roles were played only by male actors because | f. revenge, war and love. |
| 7. Actors and playwrights often relied on the support of | g. instruments of divine justice. |
| 8. Shakespeare's tragedies developed themes such as | h. but the actors had lavish costumes. |
| 9. Shakespeare's main characters often considered themselves to be | i. the rich patrons of the arts. |
| 10. Apart from William Shakespeare, other great Elizabethan dramatists included | j. on three sides. |

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

2

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There are THREE extra headings you do not need to use:**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| A. Heroes Also Die | B. Monsters Like Music | C. A Monster Ravages the Kingdom | D. Beowulf Kills Grendel |
| E. Beowulf's Father Saves the Kingdom | F. A Mighty Warrior Arrives | G. Once Again Peace Is Restored | H. Wiglaf Betrays Beowulf |

**BEOWULF**

| 1 | |
|---|---|

The story of Beowulf begins in Denmark, where King Hrothgar rules a prosperous kingdom. He builds a grand hall called Heorot, where his warriors gather to celebrate and receive rewards. However, their joy is shattered by a monstrous creature named Grendel, who is enraged by the sounds of laughter and music. Night after night, Grendel attacks Heorot, killing and devouring Hrothgar's men. The Danes are powerless to stop him, and the hall stands abandoned for twelve years.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

News of Hrothgar's plight reaches Beowulf, a young and mighty warrior from Geatland (modern-day Sweden). Seeking glory and honor, Beowulf sails to Denmark with a band of loyal companions to defeat the monster. Upon arrival, he is welcomed by Hrothgar, who remembers Beowulf's father and offers him hospitality. Confident in his strength, Beowulf chooses to fight Grendel without weapons, believing it would be unfair to use them against a creature that fights unarmed.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

That night, Beowulf and his men wait in Heorot. When Grendel arrives, he attacks and devours one of the warriors before confronting Beowulf. A fierce struggle ensues, but Beowulf's immense strength proves superior. He grips Grendel's arm and tears it off, mortally wounding the monster. Grendel flees to his lair to die. The Danes celebrate Beowulf's victory, and Hrothgar rewards him with treasures and praise.

| 4 | |
|---|---|

However, the victory is short-lived. Grendel's mother, another fearsome creature, seeks revenge for her son's death. She attacks Heorot, killing one of Hrothgar's most trusted men, and retreats to her underwater lair. Beowulf vows to defeat her as well. He dives into the murky lake where she dwells and engages her in battle. Initially, Beowulf struggles, as his weapons fail against her. But he eventually finds a massive sword forged by giants, which he uses to slay her. He also discovers Grendel's corpse and beheads it. Beowulf returns to the surface victorious once again, bringing peace to Denmark. 3

| 5 | |
|---|---|

After these heroic deeds, Beowulf returns to Geatland, where he is honored and later becomes king. He rules wisely and bravely for fifty years, maintaining peace and prosperity in his land. The final part of the poem takes place in Beowulf's old age. A dragon becomes enraged when a thief steals a cup from its treasure hoard. In retaliation, the dragon ravages Beowulf's kingdom with fire. Despite his age, Beowulf resolves to confront the dragon himself. He gathers a group of warriors, but during the battle, all but one—his loyal companion Wiglaf—flee in fear. Beowulf and Wiglaf fight the dragon together. Although they manage to kill it, Beowulf is mortally wounded by its venomous bite. As he lies dying, he reflects on his life and asks to see the treasure he has won for his people. He then names Wiglaf as his successor and dies. The poem ends with Beowulf's funeral, where his people mourn him as a great and noble king, while also fearing for their future without his protection.

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (180-200 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**

*(AI generated)*

4

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*

# CONCURSUL NAȚIONAL
# DE
# CULTURĂ & CIVILIZAȚIE BRITANICĂ
# QUEEN VICTORIA

**Ediția a V-a**

**ETAPA JUDEȚEANĂ**
**28 MARTIE 2026**

**CLASA A XI-A**

**Varianta 2**

**I. Fill in the blanks with the following words:** *Stuart, Protectorate, Parliament, Monarchy, Restoration, Divine, Succession, Republic, Civil, Sovereignty*

The 17th century in England was defined by a profound constitutional crisis that fundamentally reshaped the nation's governance. The era began with the (1) _____ dynasty, whose monarchs frequently clashed with elective bodies over the limits of royal power. King Charles I, in particular, firmly believed in the (2) _____ Right of Kings, an ideology that suggested his authority came directly from God, rather than from his subjects. This belief system led to a breakdown in communication with (3) _____, eventually plunging the country into a bloody (4) _____ War that divided families and regions.

Following the trial and execution of the King, England underwent a radical political experiment, becoming a (5) _____ for the first time in its history. This period, often referred to as the (6) _____, saw the rise of Oliver Cromwell, who ruled as Lord Protector. However, the lack of a clear plan for (7) _____ after Cromwell's death led to political instability and public exhaustion with military rule. Consequently, 1660 marked the (8) _____, as the English people welcomed Charles II back to the throne to restore traditional order. 1 _____

Despite the return of the kings, the struggle for (9) _____ did not end until the Glorious Revolution of 1688, which ensured that the (10) _____ would henceforth rule only with the consent of the governed. This transition laid the groundwork for the modern British constitutional system, balancing the influence of the Crown with the rights of the people.

*(https://courses.lumenlearning.com/atd-herkimer-westerncivilization/chapter/the-english-protectorate/)*

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**II. Match the two columns:**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. The Roman invasion left a lasting legacy through | a. the daughter of an Earl (maiden name Fitzwilliam), making her *Lady* by birth, not just marriage. |
| 2. In the *Danelaw* regions, Viking influence was | b. by her behavior at the Meryton ball. |

| | |
|---|---|
| 3. The Victorian age is often characterized as | c. the creation of urban infrastructure and paved roads. |
| 4. Elizabeth Bennet first offends Mr. Darcy | d. Pemberley, which represents his immense landed wealth. |
| 5. In *Brave New World*, the World State maintains order | e. most visible in local customs, language, and legal systems. |
| 6. Elizabeth's feelings toward Darcy begin to change | f. through biological conditioning and the distribution of soma. |
| 7. Darcy's magnificent estate is called | g. a period of industrial expansion and strict moral codes. |
| 8. The *Savage* (John) ultimately rejects the new world | h. when she reads the letter explaining his past actions. |
| 9. Celtic tribes are remembered for their | i. because it lacks genuine human emotion and suffering. |
| 10. Lady Catherine de Bourgh is actually | j. advanced metalwork and the construction of hillforts. |

2

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | | | |

*(20 points: 10 x 2p)*

**III. Match the headings to the extracts. There are THREE extra headings you do not need to use:**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| A. A Shift from Imperial Rule to Voluntary Cooperation | C. A Legacy of Shared Values and Global Influence | E. Challenges to the Continuity of the Monarchy | G. The Economic Consequences of Imperial Dissolution |
| B. The Strategic Importance of the Royal Succession | D. The Symbolic Role of the Crown in a Modern World | F. The Shift towards a Republican Form of Government | H. Military Hegemony during the Victorian Zenith |

| 1 | |
|---|---|

The narrative of the Commonwealth of Nations is inextricably linked to the slow, often turbulent disintegration of the British Empire, a process that redefined global geopolitics in the 20th century. Unlike the rigid, hierarchical structure of the imperial past, where London

exercised absolute administrative and political control, this new association emerged as a pragmatic response to the unstoppable wave of decolonization following World War II. It represents a fundamental transformation in international relations, moving away from a system of central dictates toward a sophisticated partnership of equals. In this framework, sovereign states that were once subjects of the Crown now choose to maintain institutional ties based on shared history, mutual respect, and legal precedents rather than political coercion or military occupation. This transition allowed Britain to maintain a sphere of influence while granting former colonies the autonomy they demanded.

| 2 | |
|---|---|

At the heart of this unique international organization lies the British Monarchy, though its functional role has been radically redefined to suit a democratic age. No longer an absolute ruler or a political decision-maker, the Sovereign serves as a unifying focal point, a *living symbol* of the free association of member nations. This role is almost entirely ceremonial, yet it provides a vital sense of historical continuity and psychological stability that transcends the shifting political landscapes and internal conflicts of the 56 member countries. The monarch acts as a bridge between the past and the future, presiding over meetings and maintaining personal relationships with world leaders, thereby ensuring that the Commonwealth remains a cohesive entity despite the lack of a formal, written constitution or a centralized government.

| 3 | |
|---|---|

As the record-breaking reign of Queen Elizabeth II drew to a close, the global focus shifted toward the long-term resilience and adaptability of the House of Windsor. The future of the monarchy in the 21st century is frequently the subject of intense academic and public debate, with critics questioning how a medieval institution can remain relevant in a more cynical, egalitarian, and media-driven world. The survival of the Crown's prestige now depends on its capacity to balance centuries-old tradition with the modern expectations of a diverse, globalized public that demands transparency and social responsibility. If the monarchy fails to resonate with the younger generations within the Commonwealth, it faces the risk of becoming an architectural relic rather than a functioning part of the international community.



| 4 | |
|---|---|

The transition of power within the Royal Family is more than just a matter of hereditary tradition; it is a moment of profound strategic significance for the stability of the entire institutional *brand*. Each new generation, from the coronation of King Charles III to the public roles of the Prince and Princess of Wales, must carefully recalibrate their image to ensure they remain respected symbols of national and international unity. This carefully managed continuity is essential for maintaining the *public consent*, which serves as the invisible but true foundation of a modern constitutional monarchy. Success in this area requires a delicate diplomacy—honoring the legacy of the past while championing contemporary causes like environmental sustainability and mental health, which helps to justify the institution's existence to a modern electorate.

| 5 | |
|---|---|

Beyond the high-level politics of heads of government meetings, the Commonwealth is sustained by a powerful *soft power* network—a legacy of common language, similar legal systems (Common Law), and a shared commitment to democratic principles and human rights. From the cultural celebration of the Commonwealth Games to professional and educational exchanges between universities, these non-political threads create a resilient global network. This infrastructure allows countries of vastly different sizes, geographic locations, and economic wealth to collaborate effectively on existential issues like climate change, maritime security, and trade. Ultimately, this proves that the ghost of the former empire has been replaced by a functional, modern community that provides real value to its members through cooperation and mutual aid in an increasingly fragmented world.

(https://www.nationalgeographic.com/history/article/how-the-commonwealth-of-nations-arose-from-a-crumbling-british-empire)

*(20 points: 5 x 4p)*

**IV. Write a text based on the picture below (220-250 words). Please remember to give a title to your text.**

*(AI generated)*

*(30 points)*

*NOTA: Toate subiectele sunt obligatorii. *** Total 100p *** Timp de lucru 60 de minute. Se acorda 10p din oficiu.*